

A Special Meeting of the Board of Aldermen was held Tuesday, December 9, 2025, at 7:03 pm in the Aldermanic Chamber and duly noticed in two places, including the City's website, in accordance with the requirements of RSA 91-A:2 II.

President Lori Wilshire presided; City Clerk Daniel Healey recorded.

Prayer was offered by City Clerk Daniel Healey; Alderman Tyler Gouveia led in the Pledge to the Flag.

Let's start the meeting by taking a roll call attendance.

The roll call was taken with 13 members of the Board of Aldermen present: Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Moran, Alderman Thibodeau, Alderman Gouveia, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Jette, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman Klee, Alderman Dowd, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Wilshire.

Alderman Lopez and Alderman Clemons were recorded absent.

Mayor Jim Donchess and Corporation Counsel Steve Bolton were also in attendance.

COMMUNICATIONS

From: Lori Wilshire, President, Board of Aldermen

Re: Calling a Special Board of Aldermen meeting on December 9, 2025 - update on Holiday Stroll

There being no objection, President Wilshire accepted the communication and placed it on file.

DISCUSSIONS AND/OR PRESENTATIONS

- Update on Holiday Stroll

President Wilshire recognized Executive Director Alyssa O'Mara of Downtown Nashua Association.

ADJOURNMENT

MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN THAT THE DECEMBER 9, 2025, SPECIAL MEETING OF THE BOARD OF ALDERMEN BE ADJOURNED

MOTION CARRIED

The meeting was declared adjourned at 7:36 p.m.

Attest: Daniel Healey, City Clerk



30TH ANNUAL NASHUA WINTER STROLL

NOVEMBER 29, 2025

Alyssa O'Mara, Executive Director



THE HISTORY

What began in 1995 as a small community gathering in Downtown Nashua has grown into New Hampshire's second largest community celebration (neck in neck with daily numbers for the Deerfield Fair, surpassed only by Laconia Bike Week). The Winter Stroll, held on the Saturday after Thanksgiving, traditionally features a candlelit procession led by Santa and Mrs. Claus from City Hall to the tree, a formal tree-lighting ceremony, live performances, and a dozen or so vendors. The event regularly draws crowds in the tens of thousands (commonly cited around 30,000 attendees) and has the way the city launches the holiday season.

Over the decades the Stroll has expanded from a simple procession and tree lighting into a full evening of programming across Main Street and (now) the Riverfront with ice rinks, live music, food vendors, and family attractions now accompanying the traditional candlelit walk.

Like many large public events, the Stroll has adapted to changing circumstances and continues to evolve with new attractions and layout changes driven by community feedback and logistical needs. This adaptability is part of why the Winter Stroll remains such a longstanding and beloved Nashua tradition.

2025 STATS

Food Trucks: 20

Non-Food Vendors: 22

Activities/Attractions: 10

Downtown Retail & Restaurants: 55

Performances: 57

Attendance: 24.9k (26.3k 2024)

Linger Time: 103 minutes (86 minutes 2024)





NEW IN 2025!

- Trackless Train w/ 3 stops on Main Street
- Avalanche Snow Tubing Slide
- Skating Rink
- Parade additions (Tractor, Magic Sleigh, Inflatables)

2025 FEEDBACK

“This was only my second Winter Holiday Stroll, the first being 5 or 6 years ago, and I'm so happy we gave it another shot! I want to say a quick thank you for all the work everyone put into making last night a blast. My 8 year old and I had a memorable time marked by fun, holiday joy, and a sense of community. Events like these are one of the top reasons I enjoy living in Nashua. We look forward to next year!”

Kendra Coleman, Resident, Ward 6

“Congratulations on an EPIC night. The new ideas were all incredible improvements to the flow and the new tree location is so special. Thank you!”

Sarah Jayne Howland, Miss New Hampshire Teen

“As a long-time Nashua resident, I also want to congratulate you on an outstanding event. This year truly felt like it had the most attractions and the most food vendors yet. Everyone I spoke with shared the same positive feedback. Thank you again for all your hard work on this event, we can't wait for next year!”

Allison Silva, St Mary's Bank

“I just wanted to say you did an EXCELLENT job with the Stroll. I had a wonderful time with the kids. I received a lot of great compliments from their parents along with Santa. Any future events you have I would gladly help out okay. Thanks again.”

Diane Guilbert aka Mrs Claus

Comments from the Public Safety Team via Emily Martuscello, Emergency Management Director:

“The new footprint allowed for enhanced security and safety allowing us to better use our public safety resources.”

“Pre-planning allowed for greater understanding of vendors and layout which helped with coordination.”

“GAD volunteers did a great job supporting and directing visitors allowing first responders to focus on safety.”

2025 FEEDBACK

“I didn’t get to experience most of it but I heard mostly positive feedback from people in person. We did have less foot traffic this year. People seemed to enjoy that there were more activities for their kids... I liked that Canal Street was kept open to traffic. It made it a little easier for staff to get to work. I did not like that Main St closed (at least on our end) for over an hour before vendors even started setting up.”

John Plourde, Manager, Peddler’s Daughter

“We usually do the same numbers for the Stroll as the night before Thanksgiving. We were down a few thousand for the Stroll this year. We were crazy from 7-11PM then it died down. I think it’s the trend as younger people aren’t really drinking like they used to but also we didn’t get the little bump from the tree lighting we usually do. That being said, I think having things to do on Main Street is more important than people standing in line to drink. We were still at capacity for hours and we’re happy. It was also so cold that I assume people didn’t want to stand in lines at bars and went home – I don’t blame them.”

Paige Hultman, Manager, Penuche’s Ale House

Lisa Beebe Law · 5d · 🧑🏻‍🤝‍🧑🏻

Fun night in downtown Nashua for the 30th Winter Holiday Stroll! The kickoff for the new waterfront pavilion and walkway was perfect! Great job [Alyssa O'Mara](#) and Great American Downtown!

75 ❤️ 12 💬 📎

👍❤️



Kara Marie · 5d · 🌟 Rising contributor

The ice sculptures are one of my favorite things about the stroll



Reply

 13

 



Paul G. Bergeron with Lisa Y. Bergeron in Nashua.

5d · 🌍

The Stroll was fantastic! Different but still enjoyable! Visited Court Street theatre, Arts Center, walked the new river walk, concert 🎵 at the Methodist church, gingerbread houses 🏠 at Good Shepherd Church, hot cocoa and candy canes! And got to hang out with our 12 year old granddaughter who is borderline wanting to still hang with us haha but she had a great time as well! [Nashua's Winter Holiday Stroll](#)

 **Kara Marie** · 5d · ★ Rising contributor

My 8 year old son had a blast riding the train. I hope they provide it again next year!



Reply  7  

 **Ora LeMere** · 4d
Best one in YEARS!



Reply  4

 **Larry Fortenberry** · 5d
Had a wonderful time

CHANGES FOR 2026

- Limit food trucks to 12-14
- Increase retail/holiday vendors to 40-50
- Increase attractions/rides to 8
 - Utilize side streets for rides



Cities have the capability of providing something for everybody, only because, and only when, they are created by everybody.



Jane Jacobs

THANK YOU

Questions? Comments?

We'd love to hear from you.

www.downtownnashua.org

Let's build something together!

